

Cold War Topical Paper 1 Past Year Paper Questions **2025-2021**

0470/11/O/N/25

- 7 There were agreements and differences between the United States and the Soviet Union in the build up to the Cold War.
- (a) What agreements were reached at the Potsdam Conference? [4]
- (b) Why was the Warsaw Pact established in 1955? [6]
- (c) How far do you agree that differences in ideology were to blame for the Cold War? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 Tensions between the wartime Allies developed quickly from 1945.
- (a) What did the Allies disagree about at Potsdam? [4]
- (b) Why was Marshall Aid introduced? [6]
- (c) 'The Soviet Union established communist control of Eastern Europe by crushing opposition parties.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 In 1945 it did not take long for tensions to emerge between the wartime Allies.
- (a) What was agreed about the future of Germany at Yalta? [4]
- (b) Why did the relationship between the Allies deteriorate between Yalta and Potsdam? [6]
- (c) How far do you agree that the Soviet Union caused the Cold War? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 Both the United States and the USSR contributed to the start of the Cold War.
- (a) What was agreed at Yalta about Eastern Europe? [4]
- (b) Why was the Berlin Blockade important? [6]
- (c) How far did the Marshall Plan and the Truman Doctrine have similar aims? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 The years after the Second World War saw the beginnings of the Cold War.
- (a) Describe developments in Czechoslovakia in the years from 1945 to 1948. [4]
 - (b) Once the war was over, why was there disagreement amongst the Allies over what to do about Germany? [6]
 - (c) How justified was Stalin in being suspicious of the Marshall Plan? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 In the years after the Second World War the USA and the Soviet Union grew more suspicious of each other.
- (a) What was Cominform? [4]
 - (b) Why did Stalin prevent Eastern European countries from applying for Marshall Aid? [6]
 - (c) Which peace conference achieved more: Yalta or Potsdam? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 Relationships between the Allied powers deteriorated rapidly from 1945.
- (a) What methods did Stalin use to gain control over Eastern European states by 1948? [4]
 - (b) Why was Berlin a cause of tension between the Allied powers? [6]
 - (c) 'The main reason for Stalin's policy towards Eastern Europe was his fear of invasion from the West.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 The wartime alliance broke down quickly at the end of the war.
- (a) What agreements about Germany were made at the Potsdam Conference? [4]
 - (b) Why was Poland a cause of tension between the Allied powers in 1945? [6]
 - (c) How far do you agree that Truman was to blame for the outbreak of the Cold War? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 In the years after 1945, Eastern Europe became important for both the United States and the USSR.
- (a) What was agreed at the Yalta Conference about the future of Germany? [4]
- (b) Why did communist countries agree to form the Warsaw Pact in 1955? [6]
- (c) 'By 1948 the USSR had used the same methods to take control of Czechoslovakia and Poland.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 From 1945, the United States and the USSR became more suspicious of each other.
- (a) Describe how the Soviet Union consolidated its hold over Poland from 1945. [4]
- (b) Why were the Allies determined to defeat the Berlin Blockade? [6]
- (c) 'The Marshall Plan was important to western Europe and to the United States for different reasons.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 In the years after the Second World War, the United States and the USSR did not agree about everything.
- (a) What was agreed at Yalta about the future of Poland? [4]
- (b) Why was the Marshall Plan important to the United States? [6]
- (c) 'Between 1945 and 1948, the United States and the USSR disagreed over the future of Germany.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 From 1945, relations between the USSR and the West steadily deteriorated.
- (a) Describe how the Allies reacted to the Berlin Blockade. [4]
- (b) Why were there disagreements between the Soviet Union and the West at the Potsdam Conference? [6]
- (c) How surprising was the USSR's rejection of the Marshall Plan? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 Tense relations between the Allied powers developed rapidly after the Second World War.
- (a) What was agreed at Potsdam? [4]
 - (b) Why did Stalin impose a blockade on Berlin in 1948? [6]
 - (c) Which did more to damage relations between the United States and the USSR: disagreements over Poland or Marshall Aid? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 After the Second World War the United States was concerned about the threat of communism in Europe.
- (a) What was the Truman Doctrine? [4]
 - (b) Why was the failure of the Berlin Blockade important? [6]
 - (c) Was it surprising that Britain and the United States agreed at Yalta that Eastern Europe should be a Soviet sphere of influence? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 Immediately after the Second World War relations between the Soviet Union and the United States were very difficult.
- (a) What were the main disagreements at the Potsdam Conference? [4]
 - (b) Why did the blockade of Berlin fail? [6]
 - (c) 'Stalin's policies in Eastern Europe in the period 1945–49 were defensive.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 The USA and USSR had different aims in Europe after 1945.
- (a) Describe the Berlin Blockade. [4]
 - (b) Why did Stalin want control over the government of Poland? [6]
 - (c) 'Marshall Aid did more to strengthen the Americans than benefit the Europeans.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 Hostility between the USA and USSR increased after the end of the Second World War.
- (a) What was agreed at the Yalta Conference? [4]
 - (b) Why did the USSR oppose Marshall Aid? [6]
 - (c) 'Disagreements over the future of Germany were the main cause of the Cold War.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

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- 7 The USA and the USSR both wanted to influence developments in Europe after the Second World War.
- (a) What was the purpose of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)? [4]
 - (b) Why did the USSR and the West disagree about what to do with Germany after the end of the Second World War? [6]
 - (c) 'The USA offered the Marshall Plan to European countries to help its own economy.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]